

- If you want your offer to be more competitive, you can up the purchase price, offer to pay some of the seller's fees and closing costs, or sweeten the deal with some of the non-monetary tactics we mentioned. Whether you need to up your game depends on how busy the market is and how much competition you have on this particular property, which your agent can gauge by asking the listing agent.
- Read your contract. Yes, all of it. This is a *little* more important than the checkbox agreement to download Candy Crush from the app store.